Learning to Play Dead

25 seconds | 5 activities | Real phone-video look | 9:16 Reel

VIDEO IDEA

One training session teaching play dead: starting in a sit, going down, a failed half roll, a real flop on the side with a thumping tail and a happy reward.

TIMELINE

0-5s	Ready position
5-10s	Down first
10-15s	Half roll
15-20s	Bang
20-25s	Big reward

FULL 25-SECOND PROMPT (only if your tool can make 25s in one go)

A 25-second shot on an iPhone held by the owner, vertical 9:16, 1x lens, handheld with small natural shakes, auto-exposure and autofocus, real-time speed with no slow motion, available natural light only, no color grading, ordinary lived-in home, normal phone video quality - looks like an unedited home video posted on Facebook. The dog is a real adult male German Shepherd with a black saddle, tan legs and tan face, slightly darker muzzle, upright ears, wearing a worn brown leather collar with a small metal tag, natural slightly messy coat with a little loose fur on the shoulders. It shows 5 short everyday moments joined with simple hard cuts. 0-5s (Ready position): Living room, evening, warm lamp light, soft beige rug and the couch in the background. The dog sits facing the owner, ears forward, eyes locked on the treat pinched in the owner's fingers, licking his lips and shifting his front paws. Sound: quiet room, owner saying "okay, new trick", tags jingling. 5-10s (Down first): Same living room rug, lamp light. The owner lowers the treat hand to the floor and says down. The dog folds down onto his belly right away, front legs stretched out, still staring at the hand. The couch and a basket of toys sit behind him. Sound: owner saying "down", a soft thump on the rug. 10-15s (Half roll): Living room, warm evening lamp light. The owner moves the treat slowly over the dog's shoulder. The dog leans and rolls halfway onto his side, then pops right back up onto his belly, wagging and trying to grab the treat. Sound: owner laughing "almost", rug rustling. 15-20s (Bang): Same rug, evening lamp light. The owner points a finger and says bang. The dog rolls fully onto his side and lays his head flat on the rug, eyes still on the owner. He stays still, but his tail keeps thumping hard on the floor. Sound: owner saying "bang!", tail thumping on the rug. 20-25s (Big reward): Living room, warm lamp light. The owner says yes and holds out the treat. The dog jumps up, takes it, and pushes his head into the owner's hands, wagging his whole back end and licking the owner's fingers. A few treat crumbs fall onto the rug and he licks them up. Sound: owner cheering "yes, good boy!", happy panting, crunching.

AVOID / NEGATIVE PROMPT (paste into the negative box, or add "Avoid: ..." at the end)

cinematic, slow motion, lens flare, golden glow, dramatic lighting, studio lighting, color grading, film look, perfect shiny fur, glowing eyes, human-like facial expressions, smooth drone or gimbal movement, background music, text, subtitles, watermark, extra legs, extra tail, morphing, warped paws, plastic-looking skin or fur

CLIP-BY-CLIP PROMPTS (recommended)

Make each clip separately, then join them in order. Every prompt already includes the same dog and camera wording.

Clip 1 | 0-5s | Ready position

Shot on an iPhone held by the owner, vertical 9:16, 1x lens, handheld with small natural shakes, auto-exposure and autofocus, real-time speed with no slow motion, available natural light only, no color grading, ordinary lived-in home, normal phone video quality - looks like an unedited home video posted on Facebook. A real adult male German Shepherd with a black saddle, tan legs and tan face, slightly darker muzzle, upright ears, wearing a worn brown leather collar with a small metal tag, natural slightly messy coat with a little loose fur on the shoulders. Living room, evening, warm lamp light, soft beige rug and the couch in the background. The dog sits facing the owner, ears forward, eyes locked on the treat pinched in the owner's fingers, licking his lips and shifting his front paws. Sound: quiet room, owner saying "okay, new trick", tags jingling.

Clip 2 | 5-10s | Down first

Shot on an iPhone held by the owner, vertical 9:16, 1x lens, handheld with small natural shakes, auto-exposure and autofocus, real-time speed with no slow motion, available natural light only, no color grading, ordinary lived-in home, normal phone video quality - looks like an unedited home video posted on Facebook. A real adult male German Shepherd with a black saddle, tan legs and tan face, slightly darker muzzle, upright ears, wearing a worn brown leather collar with a small metal tag, natural slightly messy coat with a little loose fur on the shoulders. Same living room rug, lamp light. The owner lowers the treat hand to the floor and says down. The dog folds down onto his belly right away, front legs stretched out, still staring at the hand. The couch and a basket of toys sit behind him. Sound: owner saying "down", a soft thump on the rug.

Clip 3 | 10-15s | Half roll

Shot on an iPhone held by the owner, vertical 9:16, 1x lens, handheld with small natural shakes, auto-exposure and autofocus, real-time speed with no slow motion, available natural light only, no color grading, ordinary lived-in home, normal phone video quality - looks like an unedited home video posted on Facebook. A real adult male German Shepherd with a black saddle, tan legs and tan face, slightly darker muzzle, upright ears, wearing a worn brown leather collar with a small metal tag, natural slightly messy coat with a little loose fur on the shoulders. Living room, warm evening lamp light. The owner moves the treat slowly over the dog's shoulder. The dog leans and rolls halfway onto his side, then pops right back up onto his belly, wagging and trying to grab the treat. Sound: owner laughing "almost", rug rustling.

Clip 4 | 15-20s | Bang

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Clip 5 | 20-25s | Big reward

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FACEBOOK CAPTION

His acting needs work. The tail gives it away every time.
Still proud of him!

#GermanShepherdNation #GermanShepherd #GSD #GermanShepherdDog #DogsOfFacebook #DogLife #DogMom #DogDad #Reels

HOW TO MAKE IT LOOK REAL

Use a real photo	Biggest realism boost: use Image-to-Video and upload the same real German Shepherd photo for every clip. Same photo = same dog in all 5 clips.
Make 5 short clips	Generate each clip (5 seconds) separately with its own prompt, then join them in CapCut with simple hard cuts. If your tool can make 25 seconds at once, use the full 25s prompt instead.
Pick the most natural	Generate 2-3 versions of each clip and keep the one where the dog moves most naturally. Delete any clip with weird legs, tail or face.
Keep the real sound	Keep the natural sounds (paws, tags, panting, owner's voice). If you add a trending Facebook sound, keep it quiet underneath.
No filters	Do not add filters, slow motion or fancy transitions - real home videos don't have them.